

Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree and a year in the Metrolinx Service Design office doing rail network simulation and modelling in OpenTrack. Now an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto, turning proposed service and infrastructure changes into defensible operating requirements.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Analyze travel and network data to establish where capacity falls short, and what that means for future service and investment.
- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, combining years of data from separate operational sources into one validated source the division reports from.
- Run assigned studies from scoping to recommendations, and write the technical reports and briefing notes that carry findings across divisions.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services, building and testing network scenarios against infrastructure constraints, speed restrictions and corridor conditions.
- Established what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, schedule reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Assessed the network effect of temporary and permanent slow orders, including how far a speed restriction carried beyond the subdivision it sat on.
- Analysed run-time and speed profile patterns across subdivisions to find where schedules were most exposed to variance, working directly from the operations data.
- Worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers to pin down the variables a service plan had to be built on.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models, working with large travel datasets throughout.

SKILLS

OpenTrack rail simulation and network modelling. Python (Pandas, NumPy) and SQL. Operations data handling, pipelines and validation. VISSIM, Synchro, MATSim, ArcGIS and QGIS. Technical reporting and dashboards. Advanced Excel.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)